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EMBASSY OF THE
UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

No. 355. Chungking, April 8, 1942

Subject: Speech by SUN Fo on Independence for Korea.

Air mail

Fe memo 3.6.42

ASSISTANT SECRETARY OF STATE
MAY 15 1942
MR. BERLE

ADVISER ON POLITICAL RELATIONS
MR. HORNBECK
MAY 7 - 1942
DEPARTMENT OF STATE

Division of
FAR EASTERN AFFAIRS
MAY 5 - 1942
Department of State

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740.0011 PACIFIC WAR/2402

PS/MNP

The Honorable

The Secretary of State,

Washington, D. C.

Sir:

740.0011 P.W./2220a

I have the honor to refer to the Department's telegram no. 218, March 25, 12 midnight and my telegram no. 287, March 28, 11 a.m., and to transmit for the information of the Department a translation of the speech by Mr. SUN Fo, President of the Legislative Yuan, which was the subject of these messages.

The translation has been made by the Embassy from a manuscript copy of the speech, signed by Mr. Sun, which has been made available by a Chinese newspaperman.

The gist of Mr. Sun's remarks was contained in my telegram referred to above.

Mr. Sun delivered his talk on the general subject of freedom for all nationalities to a public

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public meeting in Chungking on March 22, 1942, which was sponsored by the "Eastern Cultural Association" (東方文化協會). It did not attract any great interest locally, and was only briefly reported by the Chinese press. According to the Chungking representative of the UNITED PRESS (an American who does not read Chinese), the account which he cabled to the United States was based on the story appearing in the vernacular CENTRAL DAILY NEWS, which on the day following gave a short summary of Mr. Sun's remarks under the heading: "Local News". The impression in the United States, as mentioned in the Department's telegram, that it was a syndicated article by Mr. Sun, is therefore erroneous.

The Eastern Cultural Association is ostensibly a private organization under the presidency and patronship of YU Yu-jen, President of the Control Yuan. At the same time it is one of the eleven Sino-foreign "cultural associations" which receives some official support through the Cultural Relations Section of the Department of Information of the Ministry of Foreign Affairs. The head of the Section, however, has stated to a member of my staff that Mr. Sun, in addressing the Association was merely expressing his own personal and unofficial views.

Respectfully yours,

C. E. Gauss

Enclosure:

1. Translation of speech, as stated

Original and two copies to the Department by air
Three copies to the Department by pouch

891/800 China

JSS/mcl

Enclosure no. 1 to despatch no. 355 dated April 8, 1942 from American Embassy at Chungking.

Translation of Speech by Sun Fo
on Independence for Korea.

China has maintained relations with Korea for four or five thousand years - a period longer than with any other country. During this long period, China has always regarded Korea as her younger brother. There has been a traditional friendship between these two nations with similar civilizations. In the past, the Japanese imperialists misrepresented themselves to China by such terms as "same race, same language". In fact this is the correct way of describing the Chinese and Koreans.

Japanese aggression against China started from Korea. Japan's attempt to conquer East Asia may be considered as having started from Korea. Japan has held Korea for well over 40 years, since the Sino-Japanese war of 1894. The cause of the war of 1894 was Japan's desire to invade Korea. At that time, the Ch'ing regime, though dull and incapable, fought Japan to support Korea. After China's defeat, the Treaty of Shimonoseki was concluded to provide for the recognition, by both China and Japan, of the independence of Korea. Japan was afraid of interference by other countries and did not dare to annex Korea openly. Not until 10 years later when Japan defeated Russia and signed the Treaty of Portsmouth did she send a governor to Korea. In 1910, Japan compelled Korea to sign the annexation treaty and changed its name from Korea to Chosen.

Japan extended her aggression from Korea to the Three Eastern Provinces of China and thence to north China. When her insults became intolerable, China offered the July 7 resistance. Since then five years have passed. Now, all the democratic powers on the Pacific are fighting against Japan and conditions in East Asia as a whole have changed. As Japan started her aggression in Korea, her aggression will also no doubt be ended in Korea. After the war, Korea will certainly regain her independence and will force Japan to abandon her invasion of other parts of the world. Our Korean friends stated in their manifesto of March 1 that had the various democratic powers checked Japanese ambition forty years ago, thus preventing Korea from losing her independence, the second World War might have been avoided. The Japanese, an ambitious people, were not content with the annexation of Korea so they invaded the Three Eastern Provinces and subsequently north China. If China had failed to resist, Japan would not have been satisfied even if China were entirely conquered by her. Japan's ambition is really fearful. The Europeans

consider

consider that it was the German and Italian Fascists who started the present world war. This we think is mistaken. As we understand it, the German and Italian Fascists were encouraged by the failure of the League of Nations to impose sanctions against Japan following the September 18th incident, thus resulting in the outbreak of hostilities. The Mukden incident was but a step planned by Japan after the annexation of Korea. The present war, therefore, originates from the war of 1904-5 (sic) and the Japanese incorporation of Korea in 1910. The existence of Korea has an important bearing on the security of the world and deserves our attention.

To assist the weak or to help a conquered nation to regain independence is an ideal that should exist in international politics. European statesmen had no such ideal, hence the outbreak of the second World War 20 years after the conclusion of the first World War. However, we must strive for permanent peace. It is not difficult. Its prerequisite is national freedom. The Roosevelt-Churchill statement of last year, or the so-called Atlantic Constitution, provides the objective of the present war - the restoration of freedom to various nations. Some people doubt that by national freedom is meant only the 14 countries in Europe conquered by Germany and Italy. We believe that Roosevelt and Churchill are not so near-sighted as this and that they have not forgotten or neglected countries outside of Europe. The BBC has broadcast that "the United States is fighting for world freedom". It may been seen that the term national freedom used in the Roosevelt-Churchill statement refers to all parts of the world.

Should the anti-aggression powers win the present war, there will be a new world order. Not only the independence and freedom of France, Belgium, Czechoslovakia, Holland and other European countries but also those of Korea and other Asiatic countries should be restored. In addition, we believe that the independence and freedom of India, the Philippines, Indochina and other nations are also being considered by Britain, the United States and the other Allies. In fact, the United States has already provided for the independence of the Philippines in 1946. That the isolated Filipino troops continued their stubborn resistance even after the reverses of the democratic powers in the South Seas is illustrative of the wise policy of the United States vis-a-vis the Philippines which has led the Filipinos to devote all their strength to fighting desperately on the American side against Japan. Britain has now sent Cripps to India to confer with the Governor of India and we believe that a suitable decision will be reached.

On the anti-aggression front today, only China is qualified to make an upright request that the highest objective of the war be declared as being the restoration

of independence and freedom to all small and weak nations in the world. This request of ours has in fact been approved by public opinion in Britain and America. We will, in accordance with the Roosevelt-Churchill statement, restore independence, one by one, to all conquered nations. Thus we will avoid a third world war for through such exercise of the highest human wisdom, we believe history will be prevented from repeating itself.

The present world war has national, not social causes. China's armed resistance is especially a development of nationalism. There can be no dawn for Korean independence unless this nationalism wins the victory. Of course, the immediate cause of the war is the imperialistic desire of the German, Japanese and Italian Fascists to rob resources and colonies. But the present war is different from the last because of the participation of China and Soviet Russia. China's 5 year resistance has turned the objective of the war to an anti-imperialistic war of national emancipation; and Russian participation has further changed it to an anti-Fascist war. On the two continents of Asia and Europe, China and Russia are taking the initiative in striving for a similar objective - the construction of a new world of nationalism. Not only Korea, but China also desires her independence.

On the Pacific today, the chief enemy is Japan. So the position of Korea is more important than ever. Korea has a population of 30 millions and has been conquered for not more than thirty years. People over 33 years of age still remember how their country was destroyed: their bitterness is still vivid. Even those under that age have also understood the cruelty of the Japanese. If we were able to intensify the anti-Japanese sentiment of these 30 millions and organize them, we would not only hasten the collapse of Japan: we would also bring the war to an earlier end. For this reason, we should help Koreans to regain independence and arouse them to assist voluntarily the anti-aggression Allies to beat the Japanese. The collapse of Japan will automatically restore independence and freedom to the Koreans.

In order to help Korea to regain her independence, the most important thing to do at present is formally to recognize her provisional government. Nine years after the Japan-Korean incorporation, a revolution took place on March 1, 1919, in Korea when a declaration for independence was issued and a Korean Provisional Government organized. Because Korea was under Japanese occupation, this Provisional Government was established in Chinese territory and has been in China for 23 years. Before the outbreak of armed resistance, China wished to help Korea but was not strong enough to do so. This is why China had not openly resumed relations with Korea. Now, we have fought for five years and have become stronger and stronger. Not only do we now have the will; we also have the strength to help Korea.

The 50th anniversary of the war of 1894 will come in the year after next. By that day, we believe we will be able to restore conditions before the Sino-Japanese war, i.e., Korea will be an independent country and Formosa, Port Arthur and Dairen will come back to China. We will then be able to expel the Japanese robbers from the Asiatic continent and compel them to return to their three islands. We did not dream of this before the present war - not even one year ago. With 26 nations combined, however, we have sufficient strength to attain this goal and we are sure to succeed. General Stilwell, Chief of Staff of the China War Zone, said frankly to representatives of the Chinese press that Chinese and American troops must meet in Tokyo before the war may be considered won. I am confident that our slogan "fight until we arrive in Tokyo" will be carried out. For this reason, we wish Korea to regain independence as soon as possible. The first thing to do is to recognize her Provisional Government.

Unlike the Czechoslovakian and Polish Governments in Europe, which have been established only recently, the Korean Provisional Government has already a history of 23 years. It has been and is still representing the Korean nation. There is no other Korean government in Chinese territory. Thousands of Koreans in America and Russia and millions in the Three Eastern Provinces have never organized any other provisional government. All of them support this Provisional Government now in Chungking, and have recognized it as the only government which is representative of all Koreans. Since we are of the same race and same language as the Koreans, and also of the same blood, we should naturally recognize the Korean Provisional Government at once. This is important because (1) If China recognizes this government, Britain, the United States, Soviet Russia and other countries will follow our step; and (2) After recognition, the Korean Provisional Government will have strength. It will return to Korea and take charge of the homeland after the Allied forces meet in Tokyo.

If we can help the Korean Provisional Government to return to Korea, the Sino-Korean relations in future will be very intimate. Koreans will never forget us. This Provisional Government was born with China's support. Its return to Korea will be the most glorious page in the history of Sino-Korean diplomatic relations and will be a credit to China, who has always been considered herself to be the eldest brother of the Asiatic countries.

I wish to assure our Korean friends that they need not fear that China will become an imperialistic nation. China and Korea have been sister nations for the past fifty centuries. China has always supported, and has never invaded Korea. The mutual relations between the two nations will insure the security of East Asia. History and geographical features have determined these specially intimate relations. No other countries have ever had so intimate relations as China and Korea. The

Korean Provisional Government was not established in the United States, England or Russia but in China. This is evidence that the Koreans have found China especially trustworthy. We must not disappoint them.

I wish to conclude here and to express my conviction that Korea will surely regain independence and freedom and that China will surely help her to attain this goal.